



Options for Monitoring Student Progress with *i-Ready* Assessment

Curriculum Associates Guidance Brief | April 2026

Guidance Overview

i-Ready provides a variety of options for educators to plan intervention and evaluate student progress. Our approach to progress monitoring is grounded in four key beliefs:

- **Assess Purposefully:** Avoid over-assessment.
- **Prioritize the Skills:** Monitor the things that matter most.
- **Incorporate into Instruction:** When possible, include progress monitoring as part of instruction.
- **Utilize the Data:** Routinely modify instruction and student placement decisions based on the data.

This document and the [i-Ready Intervention Resource Hub](#) have been developed to support our district partners interested in integrating *i-Ready* Assessment into their systematic approach to monitoring student progress when implementing a tiered instructional framework. We know that intervention plans and resources differ from district to district, so our intent is to share ideas to inform implementation conversations. We understand that educators know best how to serve the students in their district, and our guidance is never intended to supersede any state or local provisions. For inquiries into how *i-Ready* may be used to meet any state-specific guidance regarding tiered instruction visit the [State Use Library](#).

Useful Document Shortcuts

- [Key Considerations](#)
- [Options for Monitoring Progress with *i-Ready* Assessment](#)
- [Deeper Insights into Formal Progress Monitoring Options](#)
- [Deeper Insights into Informal Progress Monitoring Options](#)



Key Considerations When Monitoring Student Progress



The *i-Ready Assessment* suite has flexible tools so educators can customize progress monitoring experiences based on the academic needs of students. We encourage educators to use *i-Ready* results as one of many data points to inform intervention problem solving, including decisions regarding growth and modifications. When determining the best *i-Ready* assessments to meet progress monitoring needs, educators should consider the following:

What is being monitored? For example, are broad measures of reading being monitored, or is the preference to measure students on more specific, discrete foundational skills?

How frequently is progress monitoring needed? Some students will require less frequent progress monitoring, whereas other students may require more monitoring to evaluate the success of an intervention.

What data is reported? Progress monitoring data tends to provide several types of comparisons that students are monitored against to determine if a student is on track to achieve a given goal. For example, is the goal to compare the student:

- To their prior performance?
- To the performance of other students in a specific class or school?
- Against expected progress across time, often represented in progress monitoring processes as the “rate of improvement (ROI)”?

What’s the trade-off between time spent on assessment and the implementation of targeted, high-quality instruction? Some progress monitoring tools that measure broad concepts tend to take longer, but they are designed to offer more information and insights about your students. More targeted progress monitoring tools are faster and leave more time for instruction, but they provide less information. There will always be tension between taking more time for assessing, gathering the best and most actionable data, and wanting to use the maximum time for instruction.

What is the purpose of collecting student data? Educators need to ensure they are supporting students with the most impactful interventions while meeting district and state reporting requirements.

Formal and Informal Options with *i-Ready Assessment*

i-Ready has received high ratings in reading and mathematics from the National Center on Intensive Intervention (NCII), a nationally recognized technical assistance center managed by the American Institutes for Research, in all three academic categories NCII reviews: Academic Screening, Academic Progress Monitoring, and Academic Intervention. Regarding progress monitoring, the *i-Ready Assessment* suite enables educators to monitor learning outcomes and growth with technology-enhanced tools to support decision making. Options for monitoring student progress can be separated into two categories: formal and informal.

- **Formal progress monitoring measures** monitor change over time and inform educators if students are benefiting from tiered instruction. The measures involve a more standardized process with valid and reliable tools used to collect data at more regular intervals to inform decisions about student responsiveness to instruction or intervention.
- **Informal progress monitoring measures** provide educators with data to determine if students are positively responding to instruction or intervention at frequent intervals as part of regular instruction. These measures include ongoing informal data collection that teachers use throughout instruction for all students. It might include quizzes, checks for understanding, and other similar questioning strategies to inform real-time instructional decisions.



An overview of *i-Ready's* options for formal and informal progress monitoring is outlined in the graphic below.

Formal Progress Monitoring

Measures to monitor change over time and inform educators if students are benefiting from tiered instruction



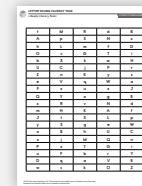
i-Ready Inform™* **(Grades K–12)**

Reading and Mathematics



i-Ready Inform's Growth Monitoring **(Grades K–8)**

Reading and Mathematics

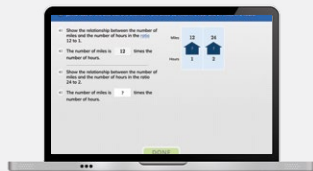


i-Ready Literacy Tasks **(Grades K–6)**

Reading

Informal Progress Monitoring

Utilizes a variety of standardized and nonstandardized measures, including curriculum materials, at frequent intervals that are embedded within tiered instruction



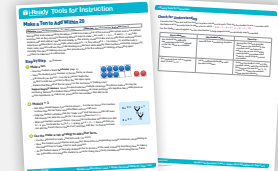
i-Ready Personalized Instruction Pass Rate **(Grades K–8)**

Reading and Mathematics



i-Ready Standards Mastery **(Grades 2–8)**

Reading and Mathematics



Tools for Instruction and Checks for Understanding **(Grades K–8)**

Reading and Mathematics



i-Ready received [high ratings in reading and mathematics from NCII](#) in all three academic categories NCII reviews: Academic Screening, Academic Progress Monitoring, and Academic Intervention. These ratings signify that *i-Ready* can be used to identify students who may be at risk of poor academic outcomes, monitor students' academic progress, and serve as an academic intervention program that addresses students' specific needs.

**i-Ready Inform™* is the new name for the adaptive assessment currently named "*i-Ready Diagnostic*."

Deeper Insights into Formal Progress Monitoring with *i-Ready*



The *i-Ready Assessment* suite provides educators with three formal progress monitoring measures, including *i-Ready Inform*, *i-Ready Inform's Growth Monitoring*, and *i-Ready Literacy Tasks*. The information below provides deeper insights into how each of these formal options can be implemented within a tiered instructional framework.

1

i-Ready Inform



Administered three times throughout the school year, results from *i-Ready Inform* can be used by educators to better understand overall progress by analyzing a student's criterion-referenced grade-level placements, national norms, and growth measures. Additionally, educators can drill down and determine progress within specific Reading and Mathematics domains. The table below illustrates the key features of *i-Ready Inform* when used as a formal progress monitoring assessment.

Grades:	K–12
Subject:	Reading/Mathematics
Administration:	Digital
What Is Measured:	Measures of reading and mathematics across key domains: • Reading: Phonological Awareness, Phonics, High-Frequency Words, Vocabulary, and Overall Comprehension • Mathematics: Number and Operations, Algebra and Algebraic Thinking, Measurement and Data, and Geometry
Frequency:	Three times per year
Available Data:	Enables educators to track progress in three primary ways: • Criterion-referenced grade-level placements • National norms • Typical Growth and Stretch Growth® targets

2

i-Ready Inform's Growth Monitoring



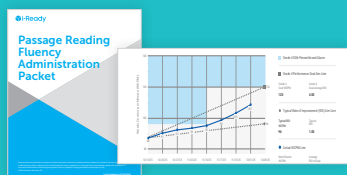
i-Ready Inform's Growth Monitoring is a shorter version of Inform intended to project whether students in Grades K–8 are on track to meet their growth goals. Administered up to monthly, educators can use results to understand student progress when provided tiered instructional supports, including high-quality core instruction, small group instruction, and intervention. For more guidance on using Growth Monitoring to support decision making for tiered instruction, reference [Using i-Ready Inform and Growth Monitoring to Understand Student Progress within a Tiered Instructional Model](#).

Grades:	K–8
Subject:	Reading/Mathematics
Administration:	Digital
What Is Measured:	Broad measure of reading and mathematics (does not provide domain-specific data)
Frequency:	Administered at most once per month and only in months without an Inform administration
Available Data:	Insights into a student's progress toward Inform growth targets
Important Considerations:	While Growth Monitoring can help identify students who need additional support to accelerate growth and gauge the effectiveness of tiered instruction, it is NOT designed to do the following: • Be administered more frequently than monthly • Provide the same data as the full Inform assessment • Offer instructional recommendations, domain-specific scores, or other granular data often needed to inform intervention problem solving



3

i-Ready Literacy Tasks



Used as a complement to *i-Ready Inform for Reading*, *i-Ready Literacy Tasks* provide a comprehensive snapshot of foundational reading skills consistent with the Science of Reading for students in Grades K–6. Literacy Tasks are modular and can be used for benchmarking and progress monitoring to best fit the specific literacy assessment needs of educators. For a detailed overview, reference the [i-Ready Literacy Tasks Fact Sheet](#). The table below details key features of Literacy Tasks when used as a formal progress monitoring assessment.

Grades:

K–6

Subject:

Reading

Administration:

Teacher-Led Digital and Teacher-Led Manual

What Is Measured:

Measures of Foundational Reading Skills:

- Phonological Awareness
- Passage Reading Fluency
- Rapid Automatized Naming
- Letter Naming Fluency
- Letter Sound Fluency
- Word Recognition Fluency
- Pseudoword Decoding—Fluency
- Pseudoword Decoding—Multisyllabic
- Spelling and Encoding

Literacy Tasks provide a comprehensive snapshot of a student's overall reading performance when paired with Inform for Reading results. Reference [i-Ready Literacy Tasks: What They Measure](#) for more detailed information.

Frequency:

For Benchmarking: three times per year following Inform administrations
For Progress Monitoring: bi-weekly and weekly (when applicable)

Available Data:

Benchmark Tasks use grade-level content to determine whether a student is meeting proficiency on foundational skills such as phonological awareness, decoding, spelling and encoding, and fluency skills.

Progress Monitoring Tasks track incremental progress on key foundational reading and fluency skills. Depending on the grade and time of year, task skills may include phonological awareness, letter sound fluency, word recognition fluency, pseudoword decoding—fluency, and passage reading fluency.

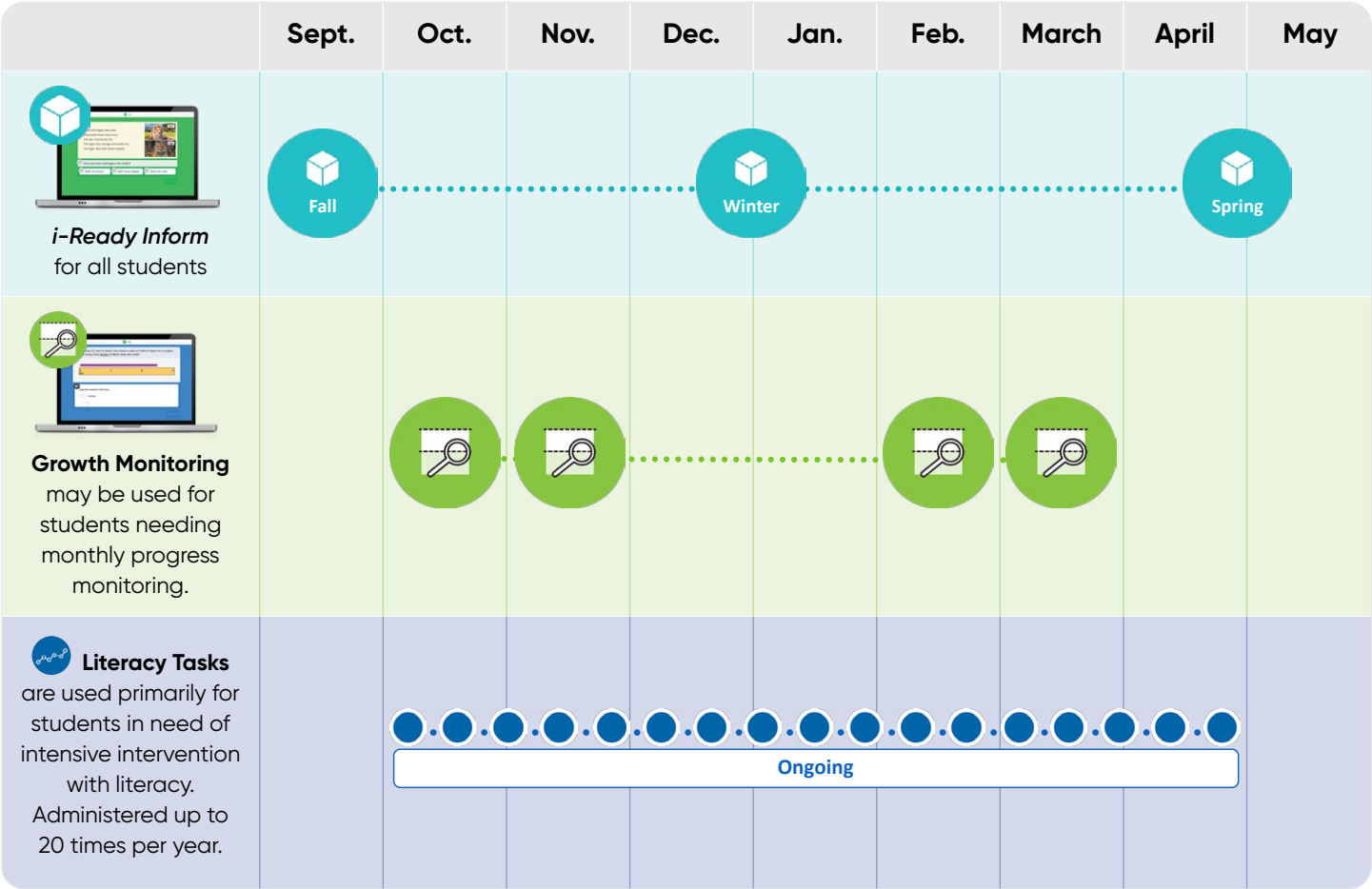
Educators can chart detailed progress to inform day-to-day intervention decisions. Specifically, Passage Reading Fluency Tasks include aim line graphs to provide deep understanding and actionable information on student progress.

Using i-Ready Assessment in Your Progress Monitoring Process



Most educators will agree that student progress should be measured repeatedly throughout the year, and the data generated from progress monitoring tools should be used to inform instructional decision making. The ideal cadence for progress monitoring depends on many factors, including the skill or subskill being measured, the rate at which the skill or subskill is learned, the student’s grade and developmental level, and the frequency and intensity of instruction or intervention that the student is receiving.

The calendar below offers one example of how a district could design a progress monitoring schedule using these formal i-Ready Assessment options.



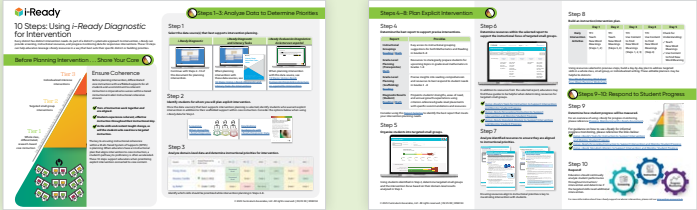
Deeper Insights into Informal Progress Monitoring with i-Ready



Additionally, the *i-Ready Assessment* suite provides educators with three informal progress monitoring measures: Tools for Instruction, *i-Ready Personalized Instruction*, and *i-Ready Standards Mastery*. These utilize a variety of standardized and nonstandardized measures, including curriculum materials, at frequent intervals that are embedded within tiered instruction. The information below provides deeper insights into how each of these informal options can be implemented within a tiered instructional framework.

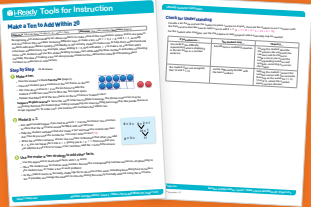
Supercharging Your Intervention with i-Ready

i-Ready's informal progress monitoring options can support educators when intentionally embedding progress monitoring opportunities within day-to-day instruction. For explicit guidance, access these [10 Steps](#) to supercharge your intervention efforts.



1

Tools for Instruction



i-Ready Tools for Instruction (TFIs) are short, skill-specific lessons designed to target students' needs. TFIs are downloadable and printable PDFs for Grades K–8 that address a variety of Reading and Mathematics domains. TFIs give educators explicit instruction and quick, on-the-spot data to informally monitor a student's pathway to proficiency and reinforce intervention learning through Checks for Understanding, which are included at the end of each TFI. For more detailed guidance when using TFIs to support decision making within a tiered instructional model, reference [Using i-Ready's Tools for Instruction to Support Intervention and Monitor Student Progress](#). The table below details key features of this informal progress monitoring assessment.

Grades:	K–12
Subject:	Reading/Mathematics
Administration:	Teacher-Led
What Is Measured:	Detailed measure of specific reading and mathematics skills and concepts identified by Inform
Frequency:	As often as appropriate and can vary by how an educator chooses to implement TFIs within a tiered instructional model
Available Data:	A Check for Understanding is included with each TFI and provides observational measures of student proficiency of a given skill or concept.



2

i-Ready Personalized Instruction



i-Ready Personalized Instruction are online lessons to support students with Grades K–8 skills and provide insight into a student's progress within a given domain resulting from ongoing instruction. Personalized Instruction can inform real-time instructional decisions for students warranting intervention through a combination of My Path and Teacher-Assigned Lessons. For more detailed guidance when using Personalized Instruction to support decision making within a tiered instructional model, reference [Using *i-Ready Personalized Instruction* to Support Intervention and Monitor Student Progress](#). The table below details key features of this informal progress monitoring assessment.

Grades:	K–8
Subject:	Reading/Mathematics
Administration:	Digital
What Is Measured:	Detailed measure of specific reading and mathematics skills and concepts taught in each lesson
Frequency:	Generally weekly. Lesson usage for students can vary* by how an educator chooses to implement Personalized Instruction within a tiered instructional model.
Available Data:	• My Path Lesson Quiz Data • Teacher-Assigned Lesson Quiz Data

*Students are recommended to spend 30–49 minutes per subject per week in total *i-Ready Personalized Instruction* usage across My Path and Teacher-Assigned Lessons. If appropriate, educators may adjust Time-on-Task to no more than 90 minutes per subject per week.

3

i-Ready Standards Mastery



i-Ready Standards Mastery gives educators deep insight into their students' understanding of key skills associated with content standards in Grades 2–8. It is designed to help educators assess individual, grade-level standards to identify performance trends and uncover student misconceptions and to provide educators with recommendations for differentiated instruction, including intervention. For more detailed guidance when using Standards Mastery to support decision making within a tiered instructional model, reference [Using *i-Ready Standards Mastery* to Support Intervention and Monitor Student Progress](#). The table below details key features of this informal progress monitoring assessment.

Grades:	2–8
Subject:	Reading/Mathematics
Administration:	Digital
What Is Measured:	Targeted mastery of individual content standards
Frequency:	As often as appropriate depending on how an educator chooses to implement the assessments within a tiered instructional model
Available Data:	Provides educators with a student's proficiency with specific content standards while also pinpointing potential misconceptions Each assessment form consists of six to 10 questions and takes 15 minutes on average to complete. For each standard (or substandard, or set of standards), there are two pre-built assessment forms available for use: Form A and Form B.